Chapter 1: The Merchant and His Family

A wealthy merchant lives with his six children: three sons and three daughters. The youngest daughter is so lovely and kind that everyone calls her **"Beauty."** Her older sisters are arrogant, vain, and cruel, spending all their time at lavish balls, while Beauty prefers reading and helping her father. Suddenly, the merchant loses his entire fortune when his trading ships are lost at sea. The family is forced to move to a small, humble cottage in the country to work the land.

Chapter 2: The Lost Merchant and the Mysterious Palace

A year later, the merchant hears news that one of his ships has returned to port. Before he leaves, the older sisters demand expensive dresses and jewelry. Beauty asks only for a **single rose**, as none grow near their country home. Unfortunately, the ship's cargo is seized to pay debts, leaving the merchant penniless again. On his journey home through a heavy snowstorm, he gets lost in a dark forest. He stumbles upon a magnificent, empty palace where a warm fire and a grand feast are magically prepared for him.

Chapter 3: The Fatal Rose and the Beast's Ultimatum

The next morning, as the merchant is leaving the palace, he spots a beautiful rose garden. Remembering Beauty’s simple request, he plucks a single rose. Instantly, a hideous **Beast** appears, furious that his hospitality was repaid with theft. The Beast declares the penalty is death, but when the merchant explains the rose was for his daughter, the Beast offers a deal: the merchant can go free if one of his daughters willingly comes to live in the palace in his place.

Chapter 4: Beauty’s Sacrifice

The merchant returns home heartbroken and tells his family what happened. The older sisters immediately blame Beauty for her request. Driven by love for her father, Beauty volunteers to go to the palace, refusing to let him die. Her father reluctantly takes her back to the enchanted castle, where the Beast treats her with unexpected courtesy, assuring her that she will not be harmed and is the mistress of the castle.

Chapter 5: Life in the Enchanted Castle

Beauty settles into a luxurious life at the palace. She is given beautiful rooms, books, and magical entertainment. Every evening, the Beast joins her for dinner. Though his appearance is terrifying, she discovers he is gentle and kind. At the end of every meal, the Beast asks her the same question: **"Beauty, will you marry me?"** Every night, Beauty gently but firmly replies, "No, Beast."

Chapter 6: The Longing for Home

Months pass, and Beauty grows genuinely fond of the Beast. However, using a magical mirror, she sees that her father has fallen terribly ill with grief over her absence. Heartbroken, she begs the Beast to let her visit her family. The Beast, unable to bear her sadness, agrees to let her go for one week. He gives her a magical ring that will transport her back to the palace instantly when placed on a table.

Chapter 7: The Jealous Sisters and the Broken Promise

Beauty wakes up in her father’s new home, and he is overjoyed to see her healthy and well-dressed. However, her older sisters—now unhappily married—are consumed with jealousy over Beauty's luxurious life. They scheme to keep her past the one-week deadline, hoping the Beast will grow furious and destroy her. Beauty, swayed by their fake tears, agrees to stay a few extra days.

Chapter 8: The Return and Transformation

On the tenth night, Beauty has a terrible nightmare: she sees the Beast dying of a broken heart in his palace garden. Overcome with guilt and realizing how much she truly cares for him, she uses the magical ring to return immediately. She searches the castle and finds the Beast lying unconscious near the rose garden.

Weeping, Beauty holds him and cries out that she loves him and wants to marry him. Instantly, a flash of light transforms the hideous creature into a handsome **Prince**.

Chapter 9: Happily Ever After

The Prince explains that a wicked fairy had cursed him to remain a beast until a beautiful woman loved him for his virtue and goodness alone. A good fairy appears, praising Beauty for choosing worth over wit and beauty. The fairy rewards the couple with a royal kingdom, while the jealous older sisters are turned into stone statues to watch Beauty's eternal happiness until their hearts soften.